

Aidan King, RHP, Florida

2026 Stats: 3.21 ERA/87 IP/1.034 WHIP/92 K/19 BB/4.84 K:BB

6-2, 205

Metrics

FB: 92.6/17.6 IVB/12.1 HB/-4.15 VAA/6.4ext/5.5 relH/45.3% zone/31.2 AA/61.9% usage/2120 rpm

CT: 84.7/9 IVB/-2.8 HB/-6.13 VAA/38.1% zone/27.1 AA/11.9% usage/2450 rpm

SL: 81.8/4.5 IVB/-8.6 HB/-7.25 VAA/36.4% zone/28.3 AA/12.4% usage/2500 rpm

SPL: 85/9.5 IVB/11.7 HB/-6.42 VAA/27.7% zone/27.1 AA/13.8% usage/1770 rpm

Write-up

Aidan King emerged as the ace of a Florida club that hosted a regional and finished sixth in the SEC, logging 87 innings while pairing above-average strikeout ability with exceptional strike throwing. He generates one of the more unique looks in the class, sinking deep into his lower half before releasing the ball from an exceptionally low release height for a 6-foot-2 right-hander. The athletic delivery creates difficult approach angles without sacrificing command, allowing King to consistently fill the zone despite the effort in the operation. The arsenal is built around a quality fastball and a deep four-pitch mix, though neither breaking ball has fully separated itself as a true out pitch. If one of the breakers takes a step forward, King has the ingredients to develop into a true front-of-the-rotation starter. As it stands, he projects comfortably as a durable mid-rotation arm with the strike throwing, athleticism, and starter's workload already in place.

The FB is the foundation of the arsenal, pairing above-average ride with meaningful arm-side movement from an exceptionally low release height. The unique release creates a flatter approach than hitters expect, allowing the pitch to play above its raw velocity despite average spin. King showed advanced feel for attacking the edges of the zone, consistently elevating to both handednesses while avoiding many true heart misses. To left-handed hitters he lived above the barrel with late ride, while against righties he effectively worked both glove-side down and arm side up to keep hitters from sitting on one lane. The whiff rate was only average at 17%, but the combination of command, shape, and

deception gives confidence the pitch will continue to outperform the radar gun. Improving the ability to consistently finish above the zone with two strikes could unlock another level of swing-and-miss.

50/55+ pitch

The CT serves as the primary bridge between the fastball and secondaries. While the raw movement is relatively stock, the pitch plays well because of King's advanced command and willingness to throw it to both handednesses. He consistently located the cutter below the belt and to the glove side, avoiding the middle of the plate and generating weak contact rather than relying purely on chase. The pitch gets enough depth to separate from the fastball without sacrificing tunnel, giving hitters another velocity band to respect. Additional depth or slightly firmer velocity would raise the ceiling, but the present command already projects the pitch as an above-average complementary offering. 45/50+ pitch

The SL is King's primary bat-missing breaking ball, featuring above-average depth with enough sweep to keep right-handed hitters uncomfortable. He demonstrated an advanced feel for burying the pitch beneath the zone, particularly to righties where it consistently finished down and glove side. The raw shape is solid rather than overwhelming, but the command allows the slider to play above its movement profile. It generated swings in pitchers' counts and rarely backed up into damaging locations. Finding a bit more finish beneath the zone and improving consistency against left-handed hitters would push the pitch toward plus, but it already projects as a dependable major league breaking ball. 45/50+ pitch

The SPL rounds out the starter's mix and may ultimately become the pitch that defines King's long-term rotation ceiling. Thrown with late tumble and quality arm-side movement, the splitter consistently finished beneath the zone to both handednesses while tunneling exceptionally well off the fastball. King showed an advanced feel for locating the pitch down and away, particularly against left-handed hitters where it consistently generated uncomfortable swings and weak contact. The present swing-and-miss rates are more solid than spectacular, but the command, movement profile, and separation from the fastball all point toward future above-average production. Continued confidence using it in putaway counts could allow the splitter to become the role-defining secondary that elevates King from a quality starter into a true top-of-the-rotation profile. 50/55 pitch